

Russell Dudek

Candidate for Director, AI Operations

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<https://russelldudek.github.io/Ontra/>

Dear Joe Dvorkin and Ontra hiring team,

Ontra does not appear to need another person who can describe AI's potential. The role calls for someone who can make AI work across departments: translate demand into a roadmap, stay close enough to the tools to solve real workflow problems, build practical training and a credible community of practice, and keep security, procurement, legal, engineering, vendor, and human-authority boundaries clear as adoption grows.

That combination is the through-line of my work. At Vape-Jet, I lead AI-first operating transformation across production, purchasing, quality, customer success, support, engineering issue flow, ERP/Odoo, Jira, HubSpot, Slack, telemetry, standard work, training, and accountability. Through DudeWorth, I build AI-readiness and opportunity frameworks spanning value, feasibility, data readiness, governance, adoption burden, reuse, and time-to-value, along with agentic workflow patterns that preserve human judgment, escalation, evaluation, and decision records.

My Amazon and Compunetics experience adds the operating discipline behind those mechanisms: launch cadence, visibility, standard work, escalation, quality systems, root cause, technical translation, and improvement in high-volume or high-consequence environments. I have learned that a useful AI intervention is not complete when the demo works. It is complete when the work is owned, boundaries are explicit, users are capable, evidence is visible, and the next team knows what was learned.

The independent candidate vision at <https://russelldudek.github.io/Ontra/> makes that thinking concrete through an AI Capability Charter and a 120-day contribution plan. The charter shows how I would connect the work, its accountable owner, operating boundaries, and proof before deciding whether a pattern should remain local or become reusable company capability.

I would welcome the opportunity to discuss where internal AI demand is already strongest, what the current mechanism protects, and where a centralized AI Operations function can create leverage without becoming a bottleneck.

CANDIDATE THESIS

Turn scattered AI effort into operating capability.

Sincerely,

Russell Dudek

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